Aaron Sierra

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CAREER PROFILE

Software engineer moving into offensive security, driven by curiosity about how systems work and how they break. Pairs production development in Python, Java, and C# with 4+ years of hands-on security work as a CCDC red team captain, Cyber@Baylor founding officer, and peer mentor. A clear communicator who turns technical findings into plain-language risk for developers, sysadmins, and executives, and a teammate who owns problems end to end, stays composed under live attack, and leads teams to deliver ahead of schedule. Native Spanish speaker.

Certifications & Rankings: CompTIA Security+ · 3x CCDC Regional Qualifier · NCL Top 4.9% (395 of 8,000) · TryHackMe Top 4%
Security Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, Fortify (SAST), SonarQube, Metasploit, Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel, OWASP Top 10
Languages: Python, Java, C#/.NET, C/C++, Bash, PowerShell, SQL, KQL, x86 Assembly
Frameworks & Platforms: Spring Boot, React, Flask, Docker, RHEL/Ubuntu, LDAP/SSO, PostgreSQL/MySQL/SQL Server, Azure

EXPERIENCE

L3Harris | Fortune 209 – Waco, TX
Junior Software Engineer **June 2025 – Present**

- Eliminated 100+ CVEs flagged by *Nessus* and *Fortify (SAST)* scans by replacing vulnerable Openfire servers with a hardened *Prosody XMPP* deployment on RHEL 8.10 and CentOS 7.9, integrating LDAP SSO.
- Owned end-to-end development of a *Python (PyQt)* client for the *JFrog Artifactory REST API* on an air-gapped network, from UML design and *Docker Compose* testing to a delivered exe with robust error handling.
- Refactored a multi-module *Java/Gradle* codebase (28+ builds) to run consistently across operating systems, standardizing build scripts for the engineering team.

Baylor University – Waco, TX
Undergraduate Cybersecurity Research Assistant **Aug 2024 – May 2025**

- Ran an authorized *penetration test* of the Baylor BRIC network: wrote the Rules of Engagement, secured sysadmin approval, and delivered a non-technical report translating findings into clear risk guidance.
- Built and hosted a web CTF (*Flask, SQLite*) with *SQL injection* and steganography challenges; rotating per-submission flags forced re-exploitation and prevented answer sharing among 30+ participants.
- Created 14+ virtual machines with varied attack vectors for Hackfest red team exercises.

Cybersecurity Student Worker **Jan 2022 – Aug 2022**

- Built weekly enterprise-style CCDC labs: 12+ Linux/Windows VMs with *Active Directory/LDAP* (100+ users), PostgreSQL/MySQL/SQL Server databases, and nginx, Tomcat, DNS, and SMTP services.

General Motors | Fortune 25 – Austin, TX
Software Engineer Intern **May 2024 – Aug 2024**

- Led a 5-person team as *Lead Software Engineer*, delivering 3 internal projects from concept to demo 3 weeks ahead of deadline, and co-presented the results to CEO Mary Barra.
- Refactored and enhanced 3 *C#* internal tools on the *Microsoft Graph API*, securing API keys with *HashiCorp Vault*.

Information Security Analyst Intern **May 2023 – Aug 2023**

- Automated alert enrichment in a *Jupyter* notebook, cutting manual lookup time by ~30%, and mapped 20+ new entities in *Microsoft Sentinel* to sharpen investigation context.

COMPETITIONS & LEADERSHIP

- **CCDC Red Team Captain:** Led red team operations for Baylor's CCDC practice program across 9 competition cycles, running full attack chains (*Nmap* recon of 12+ hosts, exploitation, privilege escalation, persistence) against hardened blue teams, then walking coaches through exploitation paths and defensive gaps in post-mortems.
- **CCDC Domain Lead:** Hardened *Active Directory* with GPO and registry controls for a 3x regional qualifying team over 2 years; the domain controller was never compromised in any engagement.
- **National Cyber League:** Exploited SQL injection and other web flaws with *Burp Suite*, placing in the top 4.9% nationally.
- **Leadership:** Founding Officer (Treasurer) and Mentor, Cyber@Baylor · Project Manager, Software Engineering II

EDUCATION

Baylor University – B.S. Computer Science | Concentration in Cybersecurity **May 2025**
Relevant coursework: Cryptology, Networking, Operating Systems, Computer Systems (x86), Database Design